



Brand Guidelines

Version 1.0 · 2026

"Learning, made luminous."

01 · Brand essence

Mission

Lumen makes complex science and technical knowledge feel approachable. We build learning tools that bring clarity to the moment of understanding — that small spark when something finally clicks.

Vision

A world where curiosity isn't gatekept by jargon. Where anyone, anywhere, can illuminate the next idea.

Brand promise

Every Lumen product earns the moment a learner says "oh, I get it now."

Personality

- Warm, not cold. We feel like a thoughtful tutor, not a sterile platform.
- Clear, not clever. Plain language beats showing off.
- Confident, not loud. We don't shout; we explain.
- Curious, not corporate. We ask better questions than we answer.

02 · Logo

The Lumen mark is built from three elements: an incoming beam of light, a refracting prism, and a spectrum of rays exiting outward. Together they form the letter L — but more importantly, they tell our product story. We take a single source of knowledge and refract it into all the ways it can be understood.



What the mark means

- The vertical beam is raw, undifferentiated knowledge — a single line of inquiry entering the system.
- The prism is Lumen itself — the thing that separates clarity from confusion.
- The spectrum of rays is the diversity of understanding that emerges — many learners, many angles, one source of light.

Primary lockup

The primary lockup pairs the prism mark with the lumen wordmark and the tagline LEARN · ILLUMINATE · GROW. Use this version on covers, hero sections, business cards, and primary brand surfaces.

Icon (prism alone)

The prism may stand alone in product UI, favicons, app icons, social avatars, and any space where the full lockup would be illegible or redundant.



App icon variant (rounded corner)



Clear space & minimum size

- Maintain clear space of at least the width of the prism's base on all sides of the lockup.
- Minimum size for the full lockup: 140px wide on screen, 35mm in print.
- Minimum size for the icon alone: 24px on screen, 8mm in print.

Don't

- Don't recolor the prism outside the warm Ember/Spark palette.
- Don't flatten the prism to a single color — the three faces are part of the mark.
- Don't stretch, skew, or rotate the lockup.
- Don't place the logo on busy photography without a solid contrast plate.
- Don't reconstruct the wordmark in a different typeface — see Section 04.

03 · Wordmark

The Lumen wordmark is set in a light geometric sans-serif, all lowercase, with one deliberate accent: the letter m is set in Ember (#D85A30) while the surrounding letters remain in Graphite (#2C2C2A). This single colored character is our subtle brand moment — quiet enough to stay sophisticated, distinct enough to be unmistakably Lumen.



Specifications

- Typeface: Inter, weight 400 (Regular). Never Medium or Bold for the wordmark.
- Case: lowercase. Never Title Case or ALL CAPS.
- Letter-spacing: -2px at display sizes. Default tracking at body sizes.
- Color: "lu" and "en" in Graphite #2C2C2A. "m" in Ember #D85A30.
- Tagline beneath: ALL CAPS, Inter Regular, 11px, letter-spacing 5px, color #888780.

Why the m?

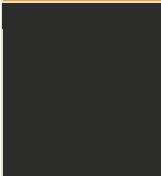
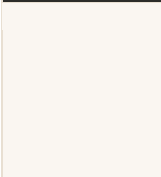
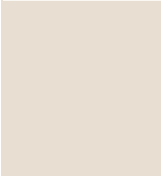
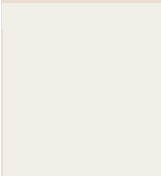
The m sits at the geometric center of the wordmark. It's also the letter that defines lumen most distinctly — "luen" reads as nothing; "lumen" reads as us. Coloring it in our brand color anchors the eye and turns a five-letter word into a memorable mark.

Monochrome wordmark

When the lockup must appear in a single color (single-color print, embossing, restricted contexts), set the entire wordmark in Graphite. Never set the wordmark in Ember alone — the m loses its purpose.

04 · Color

The Lumen palette is warm and grounded. Ember is the heart — a confident, hand-mixed orange that feels human rather than corporate. It's balanced by deep Graphite for text and a family of warm neutrals (Linen, Sand, Bone) that replace pure white.

	Ember Primary	HEX #D85A30 RGB 216, 90, 48 CMYK 0, 71, 88, 8	Primary brand color. Logo, the m in the wordmark, key CTAs, links.
	Spark Accent	HEX #EF9F27 RGB 239, 159, 39 CMYK 0, 39, 89, 0	Accent only. Highlights, focus states, top facet of the prism. Under 10% of any layout.
	Graphite Text	HEX #2C2C2A RGB 44, 44, 42 CMYK 0, 0, 5, 86	Primary text color. Headings, body copy, UI labels. Replaces pure black.
	Linen Canvas	HEX #FAF6F1 RGB 250, 246, 241 CMYK 0, 2, 4, 0	Default background. The canvas behind most content. Warmer than pure white.
	Sand Surface	HEX #E8DFD2 RGB 232, 223, 210 CMYK 0, 4, 9, 8	Secondary surface. Cards, inputs, dividers, soft sections within Linen layouts.
	Bone Tertiary	HEX #F1EFE8 RGB 241, 239, 232 CMYK 0, 1, 4, 4	Tertiary surface. Subtle differentiation for stacked panels and table rows.

Pairing rules

- Ember on Linen or Bone for primary brand moments. Never Ember on Sand — contrast is too low.
- Graphite is the default text color on any neutral. Ember only for emphasis or links.
- Spark is an accent, not a fill. Use it on small areas: dots, underlines, focus rings, the prism's top facet.
- White (#FFFFFF) is permitted only when printing requirements demand it. Linen is the brand canvas.

Accessibility

- Graphite on Linen meets WCAG AAA (16.4:1).
- Ember on Linen meets WCAG AA for large text (4.5:1). For body copy, use Graphite.
- Never set body text in Spark — contrast is insufficient on every neutral.

05 · Typography

Lumen's type system uses two families. A geometric sans for everything functional — headings, UI, body — and a literary serif for moments of voice: pull quotes, taglines, editorial features.

Primary · Inter

Inter is our system typeface. It's open-source, ships across every platform, and reads cleanly at every size. Use weights Regular (400) and Medium (500). Use Light (300) only for the lumen wordmark itself.

Secondary · Source Serif Pro

Source Serif Pro carries our editorial voice. Use it for pull quotes, the brand tagline at large sizes, and long-form content where reading rhythm matters. Italic only for emphasis — never set body in italics.

Type scale

Role	Family	Size / Weight	Use
Display	Inter	56 / Medium	Marketing hero
H1	Inter	40 / Medium	Page titles
H2	Inter	28 / Medium	Section heads
H3	Inter	20 / Medium	Sub-sections
Body	Inter	16 / Regular	Default copy
Small	Inter	13 / Regular	Captions, meta
Quote	Source Serif Pro	24 / Italic	Editorial moments

Rules

- Sentence case for everything. Never Title Case. Never ALL CAPS, except the tagline lockup.
- Line-height 1.6 for body, 1.2 for headings.
- Letter-spacing -0.02em on headings 24px and larger. Default on everything else.
- Two weights only in body: Regular (400) and Medium (500). Light (300) is reserved for the wordmark.

06 · Voice & tone

How we sound matters as much as what we say. Lumen's voice is the voice of a thoughtful, slightly nerdy friend who happens to be brilliant at explaining things.

Voice principles

- Define before you defend. Lead with the simplest version of the idea.
- One idea per sentence. Two clauses, maximum.
- Concrete beats abstract. Show the thing rather than describe the category.
- We don't use jargon to sound smart. We translate jargon to be useful.

Words we use

- Illuminate, clarity, spark, understand, explore, ask, notice, build, try.

Words we avoid

- Revolutionary, disruptive, leverage, synergy, unlock, gamechanger, seamless, robust.

Tone shifts by context

Context	Tone leans	Example
Marketing site	Inviting, curious	"Start with a question. We'll help with the rest."
Product UI	Plain, helpful	"Pick a topic to begin."
Error state	Honest, calm	"Something didn't load. Try refreshing."
Empty state	Encouraging, light	"Nothing here yet — what would you like to learn?"
Success	Warm, brief	"Nice. Saved."

07 · Application

Layout principles

- Generous whitespace. If it feels too sparse, leave it.
- Left-aligned text. Centered only for hero moments and quotes.
- Single accent color per view. Don't combine Ember and Spark as competing focal points.
- Flat surfaces only. The prism's dimensionality is the brand's only 3D moment. Everything else is flat.

Photography

- Natural light, warm tones. Avoid clinical or corporate stock.
- Real people learning, not staged smiles. Hands, notebooks, screens, chalkboards.
- Warm color grading. Pull shadows toward Graphite, not blue.

Iconography

- Outline icons only. 1.5px stroke.
- Rounded line caps and joins.
- Geometric, not illustrative. Match the language of the prism.

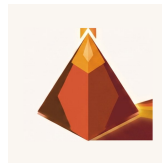
Motion

- Ease-out curves. Things settle, never bounce.
- Duration 200–300ms for UI, 400–600ms for hero moments.
- Fades and slides only. No spins, no flips.

Contact

This document is version 1.0. Brand systems are living — if something here gets in the way of doing good work, propose a change.

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lumen